

3.2.3 Spanish sound symbol correspondences

This list specifies key differences in sound spelling correspondences between Spanish and English which students will need to learn at GCSE to be able to read out loud and transcribe with sufficient accuracy at this level.

It is not an exhaustive list of all the sound-spelling correspondences in the Spanish language.

Where a letter or combination of letters is pronounced (or a sound spelt) in approximately the same way in Spanish as in English, it is not listed.

- [a]
- [o]
- [e]
- [i]
- [u]
- [ll]
- [ch]
- [ca]
- [co]
- [cu]
- [cu] + vowel
- [ce]
- [ci]
- [z]
- [que]
- [qui]
- [ga]
- [go]
- [gu]
- [ge]
- [gi]
- [gue]
- [gui]
- [j]
- [ñ]
- [v]
- [-r-] [-r]

- [rr] [r-] [-r-]*
- silent h

* word initial [r-] and [-r-] following consonants n, l or s is the same sound-symbol correspondence (SSC) as [rr].

3.2.3.1 Key stress positions and associated spelling rules (Higher tier only)

This list specifies key spelling rules determined by the position of stress, which students will need to learn at GCSE.

When reading words aloud in Spanish:

- stress any vowel that has a written accent
- stress the final syllable in a word, except:
 - stress the penultimate syllable for any word ending in a vowel, 'n', or 's' (unless there is a written accent).

When transcribing Spanish, only write an accent on the stressed vowel for:

- words with stress on a final syllable ending in a vowel, 'n', or 's'
- words with stress on penultimate (second to last) syllable for a word ending in a consonant (other than 'n' or 's').

All words with stress on the antepenultimate (third to last) syllable.